

Marketing Catch-up — August 10, 2026

Attendees: Bala, Neeraj

Bala: Sorry I'm late, the lift was broken again and I had to take the stairs. Four floors.

Neeraj: Ha, the exercise is good for you.

Bala: I do not need anyone to tell me what is good for me, thank you. Okay let me just find my notes. Bear with me.

Neeraj: Take your time. I was just reading about the Liverpool match last night. What a disaster.

Bala: Don't remind me. I watched the second half and immediately regretted it. Right, so Q4 campaign. The brief came through this morning. New pricing tier going live October 6th. We need a landing page, in-app banner, email to existing customers before it goes public, and also some social media assets apparently. The scope has grown since we last spoke.

Neeraj: Social media too? Who agreed to that?

Bala: Marketing, obviously, without asking engineering. Anyway. Let's go through it piece by piece. Landing page first. I need to brief the designer but I keep bumping it. I'll send the brief out this Wednesday August 12th, that's a real commitment, I'm putting it in my calendar right now.

Neeraj: Once the design comes through I can build the landing page. Assuming it lands by end of next week, I'll have it in staging by August 28th.

Bala: August 28th. Good. In-app banner, same deadline?

Neeraj: Yeah I'll do both together, not much extra work. August 28th for both.

Bala: Okay. Now the landing page copy. Marketing is going to claim it's not their job and it'll sit there for two weeks. Can you take a first pass? You know the product well enough.

Neeraj: Sure. I'll get a draft to you by August 20th. Short, no fluff.

Bala: Perfect. I'll make sure marketing knows to expect it from you and to turn feedback around in two days. While they're doing that I want you to also set up proper analytics tracking on the landing page so we can actually measure conversion. UTM parameters, event tracking, the works. Can you have that ready before the page goes live, so by August 26th?

Neeraj: Yes, I'll set up the tracking before we flip the switch. August 26th.

Bala: Good. The customer announcement email, I'll write that myself. Pricing messaging is sensitive and I don't want it going through five people before it sounds human. I'll have it ready for review by August 24th.

Neeraj: Fair enough. What about the social assets? You said marketing added those.

Bala: Yes, they need five or six graphics, different sizes for LinkedIn, Instagram, the usual. That's not your job and it's not mine either. I'll go back to marketing and make them own it. I'll have that conversation and confirm who's responsible by August 13th, otherwise it'll just get dumped on us last minute.

Neeraj: Please do that before they email me directly.

Bala: I'll handle it. Okay, approval process. Last campaign it took eleven days to get sign-off because nobody knew who had final say. I want to sort that out upfront this time. Can you put together a simple one-pager showing the approval chain for this campaign, who reviews what and in what order?

Neeraj: Yeah that's a good idea. I'll put that together by August 15th.

Bala: And while you're doing that, can you also put together a project tracker? Just a shared doc, tasks and dates, so nobody's flying blind.

Neeraj: I'll combine the two, tracker and approval chain in the same doc. Friday August 14th.

Bala: Even better. One more thing. The pricing page on our main site also needs to be updated when the new tier goes live. It's separate from the landing page. Can you scope out what changes are needed there and get back to me with an estimate by August 19th? Not the actual change yet, just tell me how big a job it is.

Neeraj: Scoping only by August 19th, yes I can do that.

Bala: Great. I think that's everything campaign related. Oh, completely off topic, have you tried that new ramen place that opened near the office?

Neeraj: Yes! I went last week. The tonkotsu is incredible.

Bala: I keep walking past it and the queue puts me off.

Neeraj: Go at 11:30 before the lunch crowd. No queue at all.

Bala: That's actually useful advice. Alright, I think we're done. Let's check in after you send the copy draft.

Neeraj: Sounds good.